AI2ORBIT PROJECT

UK MOBILE DATA MARKET

Pricing · Handset Ex-Factory Margins · Marketing & Market Context

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Content Table

AI2ORBIT PROJECT — UK MOBILE DATA MARKET

A market analysis of UK mobile data pricing, handset margins and marketing — with a machine-readable sample feed

SIM-Only Pricing Landscape

- Four physical networks + MVNOs
- Headline £/month by tariff
- Price-per-GB spread
- Where the cheap data really is

Handset Ex-Factory Margins

- Bill-of-materials → ex-factory → RRP
- Gross margin & markup ×BOM
- iPhone / Galaxy worked examples
- Modelled vs measured, flagged

Market & Marketing Context

- ARPU postpaid / prepaid
- 5G coverage & data growth
- MVNO consumer share
- Marketing spend & CPA (your inputs)

Report-Engine Sample Feed

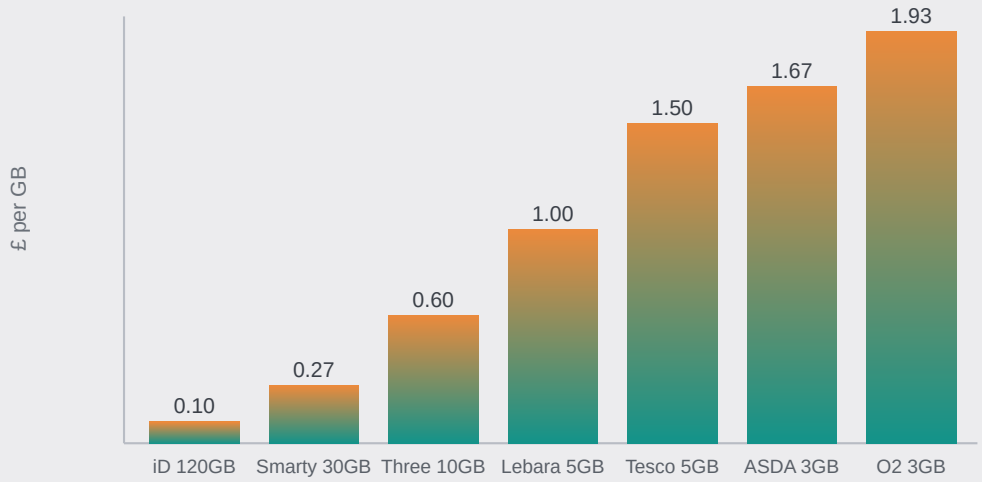
- Three tidy CSV tables + JSON
- One deterministic generator
- Data dictionary & assumptions
- How to widen it for v2

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SIM-Only Pricing Landscape

Price per GB — the real spread

Cheapest effective data is an MVNO large bundle; own-brand MNO plans carry a big per-GB premium



Widest per-GB gap

19×

O2 3GB (£1.93/GB) vs iD Mobile 120GB (£0.10/GB)

- ✓ Networks: EE, O2, Vodafone, Three
- ✓ MVNOs resell the same masts far cheaper
- ✓ Big bundles crush the per-GB rate
- ✓ All figures measured, mid-2026 list prices

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Networks & the MVNOs on Them

Four physical networks carry every SIM in the UK — most value brands ride on them

EE / Three	The two premium-coverage MNOs. Three is the price leader (unlimited £22); EE the priciest (unlimited £40). Smarty & iD Mobile resell Three from £3.90.
Vodafone	Unlimited £26. Hosts Voxi (unlimited £15), Lebara (5GB £5) and ASDA Mobile — value brands on Vodafone masts.
O2 (VMO2)	Entry SIM from £5.80, EU roaming across the range. Hosts Giffgaff and Tesco Mobile; VMO2 closed 2024 with 45.7M connections.
MVNO layer	Sky Mobile + Tesco Mobile alone hold >15% of the consumer segment — the cheapest per-GB data in the market lives here.

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SIM-Only Tariffs (Measured)

Headline list prices, mid-2026 · ∞ = unlimited · £/GB blank where unlimited

Operator	Type	Runs on	Plan	Data	£/mo	£/GB	Roam EU
Three	MNO	Three	Unlimited SIM	∞	22.00	—	yes
EE	MNO	EE	Unlimited SIM	∞	40.00	—	yes
O2	MNO	O2	Entry SIM	3	5.80	1.93	yes
Vodafone	MNO	Vodafone	Unlimited SIM	∞	26.00	—	yes
Smarty	MVNO	Three	~30GB rolling	30	8.00	0.27	yes
iD Mobile	MVNO	Three	120GB	120	12.00	0.10	yes
iD Mobile	MVNO	Three	Unlimited	∞	16.00	—	yes
Lebara	MVNO	Vodafone	5GB	5	5.00	1.00	yes
Voxi	MVNO	Vodafone	Unlimited	∞	15.00	—	yes
Tesco Mobile	MVNO	O2	5GB	5	7.50	1.50	yes
ASDA Mobile	MVNO	Vodafone	3GB	3	5.00	1.67	yes

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Handset Ex-Factory Margins

Cost → ex-factory → RRP waterfall

BOM measured; ex-factory modelled at BOM × 1.30; RRP shown ex-VAT · FX £0.79/USD

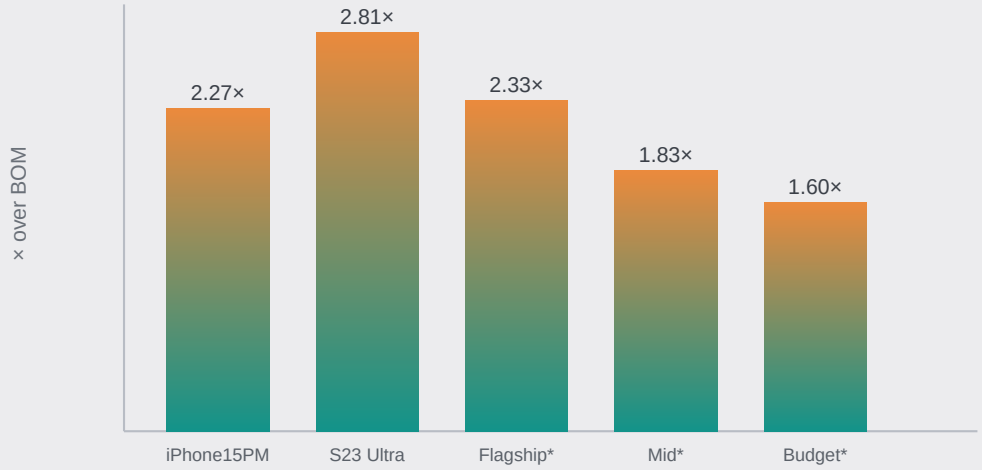
Model	BOM £	Ex-factory £*	RRP ex-VAT £	Gross margin	Markup ×BOM	Basis
iPhone 15 Pro Max	440.82	573.07	999.17	55.9%	2.27×	measured
Galaxy S23 Ultra	370.51	481.66	1040.83	64.4%	2.81×	measured
Flagship (generic)	410.80	534.04	958.33	57.1%	2.33×	**modelled**
Mid-range (generic)	181.70	236.21	332.50	45.4%	1.83×	**modelled**
Budget (generic)	82.95	107.84	132.50	37.4%	1.60×	**modelled**

***Ex-factory is modelled, not a quoted number.** Real ex-factory prices are confidential. BOM excludes assembly, software, IP/royalties, logistics, warranty and marketing — the gross margin is the pool those are paid from, not net profit.

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How Much Above Cost Phones Sell

RRP (ex-VAT) as a multiple of bill-of-materials



Flagship gross margin

56–64%

of ex-VAT trade value, over raw BOM

- ✓ Flagships mark up ~2.3–2.8× BOM
- ✓ Margin thins toward budget tiers
- ✓ * modelled tiers, clearly flagged
- ✓ Change one constant to re-price all

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Market & Marketing Context

Where the money and the growth sit — with two slots reserved for your marketing figures

Postpaid ARPU
£15.73
per month · 2023 · prepaid £5.18

5G SA coverage
83%
of UK population · 2025

Data usage
+18%
year-on-year · 2025

MVNO consumer share > 15% — Sky Mobile + Tesco Mobile alone, on wholesale deals with the physical networks.

Marketing (modelled placeholders): spend ≈ 12% of revenue · CPA ≈ £18 per SIM. Send your real numbers and they flow straight through.

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The Report-Engine Sample Feed

One generator, three tidy tables, fully reproducible

Everything below is driven by gen_sample.py — deterministic JSON checksum a792719cdd4e03a6

File	What it is
plans.csv	14 SIM-only tariffs + £/GB
handsets.csv	5 handset margin waterfalls
market.csv	8 context / marketing metrics
uk_data_market_sample.json	all three + meta/assumptions
gen_sample.py	regenerates; --check verifies
data_dictionary.md	column schema + assumptions

Honesty labels

Every row is **measured** (reported, see source) or **modelled** (from a stated assumption — not a quote).

To make v2 exact

1 · your report-engine's column names/format
2 · your real marketing figures

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Sources & Method

Measured = reported figure · Modelled = computed from a stated assumption, clearly flagged

- ✓ SIM-only pricing — UK operator price lists & comparison sites, mid-2026 (measured)
- ✓ Handset BOM — TechInsights / IHS-style teardown estimates (measured); ex-factory modelled at BOM × 1.30
- ✓ ARPU — Ofcom / Statista, 2023 (measured)
- ✓ 5G coverage & data growth — Ofcom Connected Nations 2025 (measured)
- ✓ MVNO share — market reports, 2025 (measured)
- ✓ Marketing spend & CPA — modelled placeholders, awaiting client figures

Modelling constants: FX £0.79 / USD · ex-factory ×1.30 · VAT 20% — all editable in gen_sample.py; change one and the whole dataset re-prices. This is a sample deck — say the word and I'll widen the plan set, add handsets, or swap in your own numbers.

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